

Witch' s Tower

Game Design Document

DIT_5304 – Game Engines and Game Development

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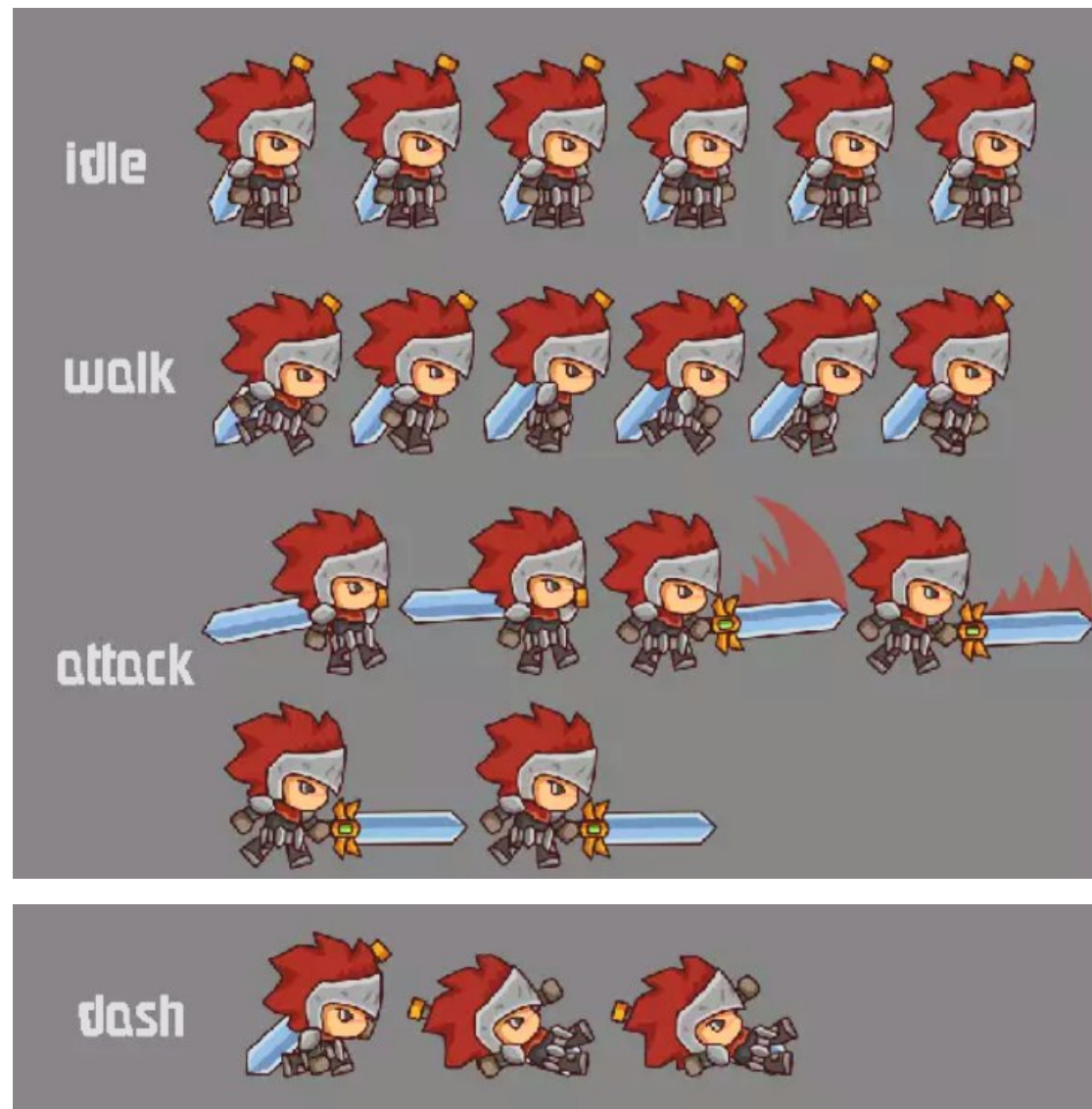
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Project Description

Witch's Tower is a 2D action-adventure game developed in Unity Engine. The core concept revolves around a romantic courtship where the player embodies a brave knight climbing a perilous tower to win the heart of a secluded witch. Gameplay emphasizes exploration, platforming challenges, and combat encounters, with a unique mid-game twist involving gravity reversal that flips the entire tower upside down. This mechanic not only extends gameplay but also symbolizes the theme of love turning one's world upside down.

This is a single-player game with an estimated playtime of 1-2 hours, divided into a forbidden forest map which is a tutorial for players and the main tower map of the story and a mirrored flipped version for the return journey. The development focuses on core features like movement, combat, and gravity flip.

Characters





Vell (Knight): The playable character, a young and idealistic knight from a humble village. Motivated by a childhood dream vision of Elyse, Ryan is determined to prove his worth through bravery and empathy.

Animations: idle, walk, attack, dash, jump, hurt and death.

Personality: Optimistic and persistent



Elyse (Witch): The tower's enigmatic resident, cursed with eternal youth and isolation. She designed the tower's traps to test suitors, hiding her loneliness behind arrogance.

Personality: Initially cold and mocking.

Enemies: Enemies created by Elyse to test suitors who come to her tower.



Game story

In the enchanted land of Edania, the legendary witch Elyse resides in the Phantom Tower, a towering structure shrouded in mist at the heart of a forbidden forest. Cursed by her family centuries ago to eternal youth and confinement within the tower. If Elyse leave the tower, she died. She was Isolated and untouched by love. One day, she performed divinations daily, and unlike the lonely future she had always been prophesied about, a new prophecy suddenly appeared: Love will turn the world upside down. She didn't know what the prophecy meant, but she was certain that love was the only key to breaking the curse. Then she issues a public challenge: "Whosoever reaches my pinnacle shall claim my companionship for eternity." This is not merely a recruitment for a partner but a desperate bid to break her emotional solitude.

Vell, a village orphan haunted by childhood dreams of Elyse's sorrowful visage. After hearing the witch's declaration, he embarked on his journey to win her heart. As he ascends to the top of tower, a heartfelt confrontation leads to a true love's kiss, but it awakens the curse's backlash—the tower's core crystal shatters, inverting gravity and flipping the world upside down. Vell must now descend (or "reclimb") the inverted tower from its new "top" (the original base) back to Elyse, proving his unwavering devotion. The story culminates in reunion, curse-breaking, and a romantic resolution, emphasizing themes of empathy and perseverance.

Game Theme

Witch's tower blends dark fantasy with romantic comedy. The game's theme is "Love Turns the World Upside Down." This is reflected in the game's gravity-flipping mechanic. During their climb, Vell and Elyse's kiss triggers a gravity flip, turning the entire world upside down. Platforms become ceilings, thorns fall from above, and familiar paths twist into mazes, symbolizing how profound love can disrupt the normal order of life. The map and combat are "reversed" during the flip phase, reflecting emotional turmoil and proving that love's chaos leads to harmony.

Story Progression

Witch's Tower is designed as linear story. It follows a chronological path from beginning to end, with events unfolding in the order they happened, making it easy for the player to follow. It can be divided into the following levels:

1. Forbidden Forest: Tutorial introduction for player; Vell walks through the forest.
2. Tower Base: Vell enters the tower.

3. Mid-Tower: Vell climbs up to the tower.
4. Tower Top Summit: Climax cutscene with dialogue and kiss, triggering gravity flip. Tower inverts; Vell "falls" to the new base (original top).
5. Flipped Tower Descent: Reversed levels with new paths.
6. Reunion at Flipped Bottom (Original Top): Ending cutscene with curse-breaking embrace, romantic CG, and credits

Gameplay

The gameplay of Witch's Tower is to explore vertical levels (Tower), combat enemies and parkour. It is side scrolling with a focus on precise platforming in an interconnected tower world. The objective is to reach the tower top initially, and then reascend the flipped version to reunite with Elyse.

Game Mechanics

Movement Mechanics: Vell can walk, run, jump and dash. The variable jump height is based on button hold. Vell can also double jump and dash in the air.

Combat Mechanics: Vell can do melee attack using his sword. He can use his sword to slash the enemies. When he explores a checkpoint in the tower, the HP would be regenerated. When the enemies discover Vell in their detected ranges, they would keep chasing and attack Vell until they killed by Vell.

Physics and Environment: Unity 2D Rigidbody would be used for realistic jumps/falls. For the gravity flip, a new scene would be created. The scene contains the upside-down version of the whole tower. When Vell reaches the tower top, the gravity flip is triggered. It would have shaking effect and teleport Vell into the following scene to make players believe the world had really turned upside down. For the environment, some of the ground of the tower would have spikes. When Vell fall into the spikes, he would be death instantly and respawned at the previous check point.

Progression and challenge

The progression is vertical and linear. Players start at the forest base and try to explore the environment and access higher areas. The flipped tower reuses levels with modifications—new enemy placements and hidden shortcuts after the tower flipped.

The challenges would scale gradually. In early level (Forbidden Forest), it focuses on basic platforming and sparse enemies. In mid-levels (Tower before flipped), it introduces advanced platforming and appropriate enemies. When the tower flipped, the difficulty would increase a lot. Enemy waves would be increased and there are some gravity-specific hazards (e.g., falling spikes from "ceilings"). Players need to overcome this challenge.

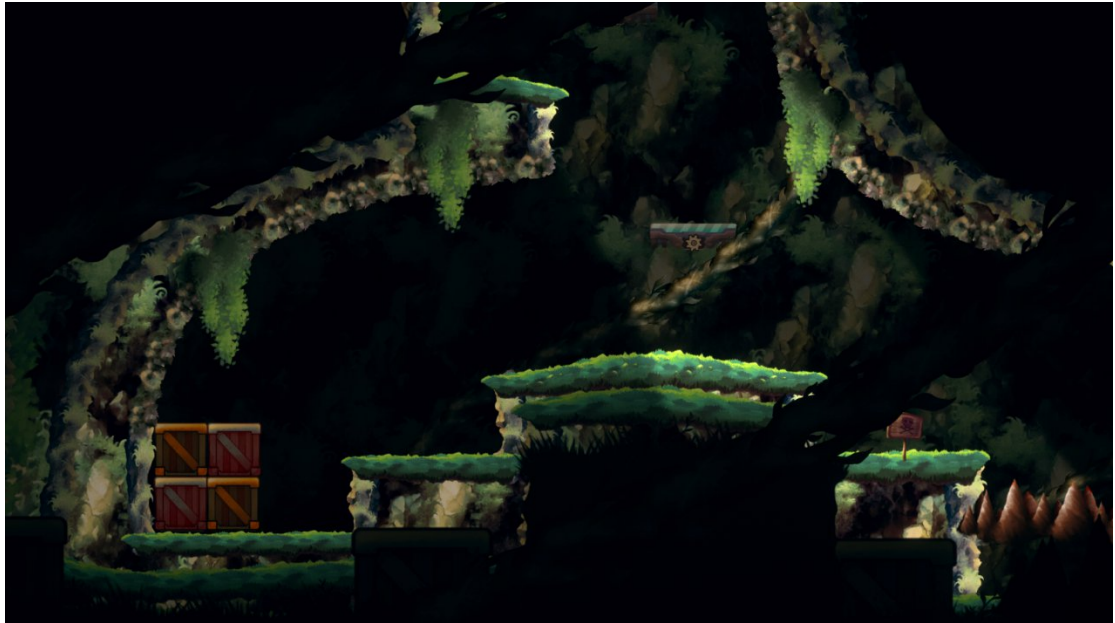
Losing

No game over in this game. When Vell death, he will respawn with full HP at the last checkpoint with no progress loss. This losing condition encourages players to retry many times until they attain the next checkpoint. The win condition is to control Vell successfully reach the flipped tower's bottom, reunion with Elyse, broke her curse completely and the most important thing is to win her heart.

Art style

The art style is a hybrid of hand-drawn and pixel art. The Forbidden Forest uses dark colors to highlight the eerie atmosphere of the forest. When Vell walks through the forest, he will see the tower and enter into it. The tower's stone walls are predominantly dark blue, while the doors and platforms are mainly wood-colored, and the spikes are silver. In the mid-tower, there is a floor with a library as its background, because Elyse loves reading books and studying magic.

Forbidden Forest

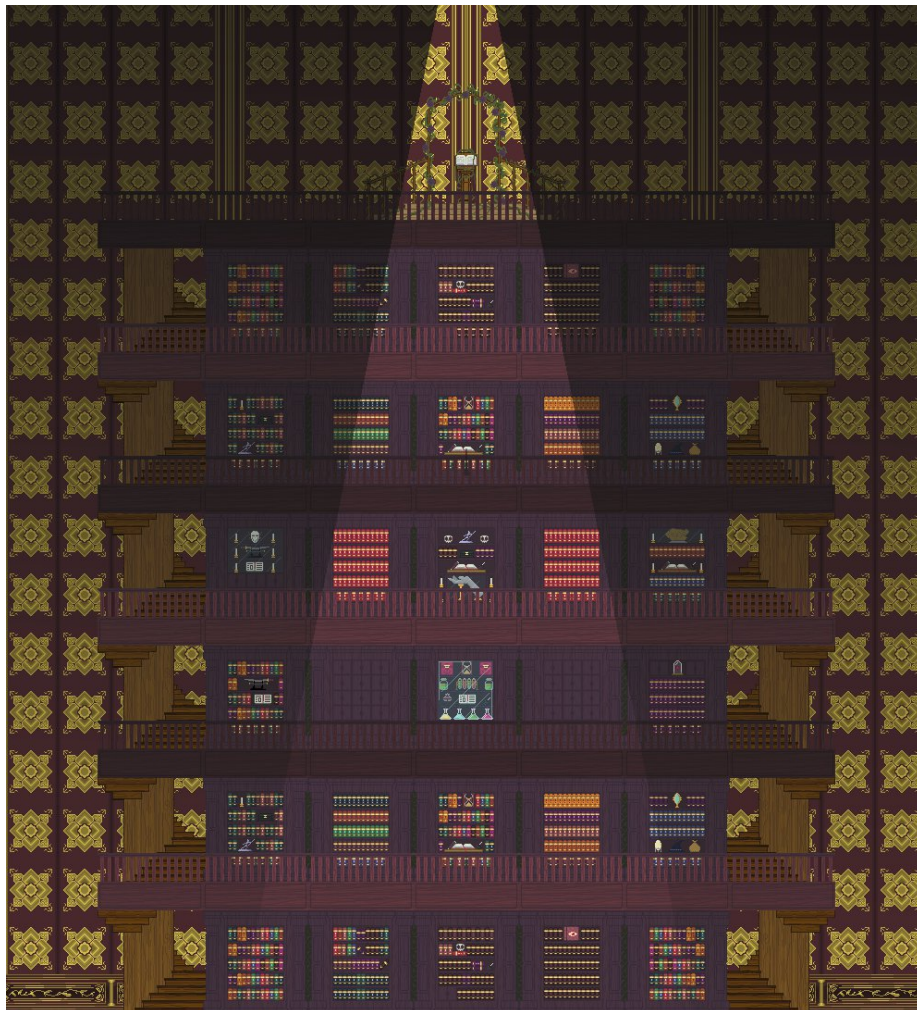


Tower entrance



Tower (Wall, door, platform and spikes)

Library Background



Music and Sounds

Music: There are three background music tracks to enhance the atmosphere:

1. An eerie melody to accompany the exploration of the forest and tower.
2. A tense melody to highlight the battles.
3. A romantic melody to complement the ending.

Sound Effects:

1. Footsteps
2. Dash
3. Sword slash
4. Hurt
5. Enemy deaths
6. Shaking sound of gravity flip

Voice Acting: No Voice Acting for the character. All dialogue would be using text boxes to exhibit.